ST MARY'S DSG, KLOOF

GRADE: 10 **TERM 1 2025**

ENGLISH HOME LANGUAGE: COMPREHENSION AND LANGUAGE (LO: READING AND VIEWING)

TIME: 1 HOUR (55 minutes + 5 minutes reading time) **TOTAL: 35 MARKS**

EXAMINER: MRS V LAMPLOUGH
MODERATORS: GRADE 10 TEACHERS

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. This cycle test consists of 7 pages. Please ensure your question paper is complete.
2. Answer all of the questions in your own words unless instructed to do otherwise.
3. Read the questions carefully.
4. Please number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
5. Draw a right hand margin on each page and do not write in it.
6. It is in your own interest to write legibly and to present your work neatly.

TEXT 1

I'm so not an astronaut!' Samantha Harvey on her Booker-winning space novel

By Lisa Allardice

1 Samantha Harvey very nearly gave up on her novel *Orbital,* which last night won this year's Booker prize. Set on the International Space Station (ISS) 250 miles from Earth, *Orbital* follows the day-to-day lives of four astronauts and two cosmonauts as they hurtle through the universe at 17,500mph. She was a few thousand words in and suddenly lost her nerve. She felt she was trespassing in space. "I am so spectacularly not an astronaut," she laughs, when we meet for coffee the morning after the Booker ceremony. "I'm so unadventurous, so unaudacious, so impractical, cowardly, anxious. I would be terrible."

2 After a few months of dabbling with other ideas, she opened the abandoned word document on her computer by mistake. When she read it she found it had an integrity and pulse that drew her more than any of the other projects she was working on. "I thought, 'I shouldn't be afraid of this. If I can do it in a way that's different to the way astronauts write about their time in space, then maybe there's something here." So she climbed back in and achieved lift-off.

3 *Orbital*, her fifth novel, is a beautiful, powerful and utterly original work of fiction. It takes place over one day, but time is different in space, where "the whipcrack of morning arrives every ninety minutes" and the sun is "up-down-up-down like a mechanical toy". Each of the 16 chapters records a single orbit of Earth. Mundane tasks – vacuuming the capsule, monitoring mice and microbes – are set against the munificence of the universe. One of the toilets is always blocked. A super-typhoon is gathering over the Philippines. Each of the six characters are given only slivers of backstory: Chie's mother has died; Anton has fallen out of love with his wife; Shaun longs for his.

4 While it might be set in space, its subject is Earth. It is a 136-page love letter to our troubled planet – she calls it "space pastoral", a kind of nature writing of the universe. "I wanted to write a celebration of the Earth's beauty, but with a sense of sorrow or a pang of loss because of what we're doing to it," she says.

5 Harvey has explored philosophical questions of being, time, faith and memory in her fiction, which also includes *All Is Song* (2012) and *Dear Thief* (2014). With each novel she has broached new ground formally. But it is her 2020 memoir of her year-long struggle with insomnia, *The Shapeless Unease*, with which she feels *Orbital* has most in common – her own cyclical bouts of darkness and distorted time, not so dissimilar to that experienced by the astronauts.

6 “I pretty much hit 40 and became anxious,” she says. “I don’t know why. I think maybe I just decided it was time to have some sort of crisis.” Suddenly, she could no longer sleep. “I was finding the world kind of abrasive. Everything was too noisy and too busy and too huge.”

7 She found her escape both in front of her nose and 250 miles away. She takes the idea of an armchair traveller to a new frontier, spending “thousands and thousands” of hours orbiting the globe in cyberspace. Her sleeplessness also gave her a heightened sense of happiness and joy, and it was from this euphoric place – “almost like being in love” – that she set out to write Orbital. Insomnia even changed how she writes: both her memoir and Orbital were completed in short, concentrated bursts. That way “everything feels much more urgent”.

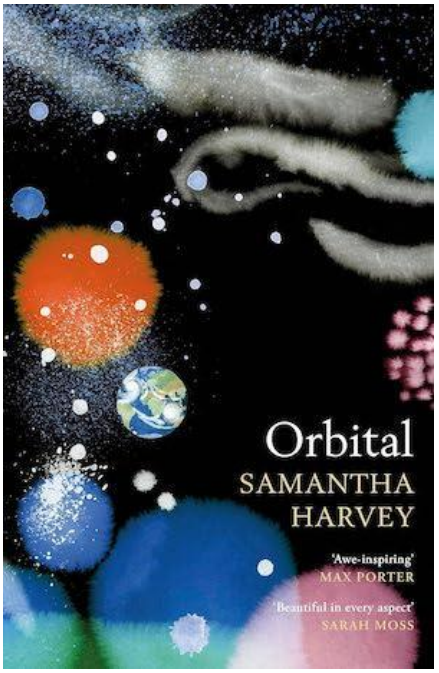
8 Although she started *Orbital* before the pandemic, most of it was written during lockdown. She always had footage from the International Space Station playing on her desktop. “It was enormous consolation to me to be able to go to space every day, virtually in my imagination,” she says. “When I’m down here on Earth, I find it difficult to be consoled by the things that we’re doing to the Earth and to one another. But when I zoom out, I can feel something that more resembles peace. I can look at it almost without judgment, just look at its beauty.”

9 Readers often ask her if *Orbital* is written from a position of hope or despair. That is up to us to decide, she says. In the novel, the ISS is passed by a rocket on a new mission to the moon. She feels that the era of international co-operation is coming to an end. “I always marvel at this about the human race. When we look at the things we do for one another and the way that we work together and make things happen, it’s remarkable. And very beautiful. Whether that’s enough, or whether our tendency towards just growing and consuming will outweigh our generosity and co-operation, I just don’t know.”

https://www.theguardian.com/books/2024/nov/13/samantha-harvey-interview-booker-winning-novel-orbital?

Glossary:
Audacious (paragraph 1): an unwillingness to take risks
Munificence (paragraph 3): quality of being extremely generous
Pastoral (Paragraph 4) : of, characterized by, or depicting rural life, scenery
Abrasive (Paragraph 6):showing little concern for the feelings of others; harsh

TEXT 2



TEXT 3



www.facebook.com/madamandevecartoon

TEXT 4



www.cartoonstock.com

TEXT 5



www.cartoonstock.com

Refer to Text 1

1. Examine the title " *I'm so not an astronaut!' Samantha Harvey on her Booker-winning space novel."*
Provide two reasons as to why you think the title of this article might attract a reader's attention. (2)

2.1. Refer to paragraphs 1 and 2.
Explain why Samantha Harvey felt that she was "trespassing in space". (2)

2.2. Despite initially feeling she was "trespassing in space", what made her continue to write the novel? (2)

3. Refer to paragraph 2: "So she climbed back in and achieved lift-off."
Identify the figure of speech used in this sentence and discuss why it is effective in the context of the article. (3)

4. Refer to paragraph 3: "Time is different in space."
Explain how Harvey has structured her novel to capture the idea that "time is different in space". (2)

5. Refer to paragraph 3.
"Munificence" is the "quality of being extremely generous". Give two reasons why you feel that setting "mundane tasks" in contrast to the "munificence" of space would be an effective story telling technique. (3)

6. "Each of the six characters are given only slivers of backstory: Chie's mother has died; Anton has fallen out of love with his wife; Shaun longs for his." (paragraph 3)
Explain the use of the colon and semi-colons in this sentence. (2)

7. Discuss what the diction in paragraph 4 reveals about Harvey's attitude or feelings towards the Earth. Quote to support your answer. (3)

8. In your own words, describe how Harvey took "the idea of an armchair traveller to a new frontier"(paragraph 7). (3)

9. Evaluate why you think Harvey found going to space virtually such a consolation for her both during lockdown and after it. Refer closely to the passage in your answer. (3)

10. Refer to the book cover (TEXT 2).
Analyse the book cover (TEXT 2) and decide how effective it is at capturing the essence of Harvey's book that we have learned about in the article. Refer to both the visual and textual elements in your answer. (3)

11. Refer to the cartoon.(TEXT 3).

    11.1. Discuss the technique used in this cartoon to convey humour. (2)

    11.2. Explain why the onomatopoeia is written in bold, large capital letters. (2)

12. Refer to TEXTS 4 and 5.

    12.1. Evaluate which cartoon (TEXT 4 or TEXT 5) you feel Harvey could refer to in order to further support her views expressed in the article. Provide reasons for your answer and refer to both your chosen text and TEXT 1. (3)

TOTAL 35